

An Introduction to Proof via Inquiry-Based Learning

Errata

Dana C. Ernst

September 16, 2026

All errors/improvements listed below have been corrected in the version of the book that has been compiled from the current source. Page numbers below reference the print version of the textbook published by AMS/MAA Press.

If you think you have found any errors not already listed here, please submit an issue on [GitHub](#) or send me an email at dana.ernst@nau.edu.

- Page x, line –5: Replaced “undoubtably” with “undoubtedly”. Although, perhaps the former is acceptable. [Pietro Monticone]
- Page 6: Fixed typo in acknowledgement for Carol Schumacher. [Chris (Karl) Reger]
- Page 11: Added some commentary to clarify use of “theorem” vs “proposition”. [Inspired by David Austin]
- Page 14, line 7: Deleted extra “the”.
- Page 15, line –7: Added “are” between “we” and “defining”. [Elizabeth Shute]
- Page 18, line 11: Added missing “of” and removed extra “on”. [Luiz Filipe]
- Page 19, lines 5–6: Removed the potentially-misleading sentence “Moreover, the converse and inverse of a conditional proposition do not necessarily have the same truth value as each other.” [Inspired by David Austin]
- Page 29, line 19: Replaced “to proof that” with “to prove that”. [Luiz Filipe]
- Page 31, Problem 2.79: Removed spurious “a” in “...is a not a nugget...”. [Eliza Todd]
- Page 31, Skeleton Proof 2.82: Added missing left parenthesis at end of $(\forall x)(A(x) \implies B(x))$ in first sentence.
- Page 33: Removed spurious “and” between “versus” and “positive”. [Shaye Fordring]
- Page 38: Technically, what was written for definition of the rational numbers was not in set-builder notation. The definition of $\mathbb{Q}$ is now written in set-builder notation and there is a comment afterwards about how this notation is often abbreviated. [Jason Siefken]
- Page 39, line –1: Removed spurious “s”. [Luiz Filipe]
- Page 52, line 1: Replaced “isn” with “is”.

- Page 54, Theorem 4.2: It would be nice if Item (ii) began “for all $k \geq 1$ ”. This is an instance of an implicit universal quantifier for a conditional statement. In this case, the implicit universe of discourse is the set of natural numbers. However, including “for all $k \geq 1$,” leads to a nice parallelism with Theorem 4.9. [Ben Ford]
- Page 56, Theorem 4.9: Item (ii) should start with “for all $k \geq a$,”. [Ben Ford]
- Page 57, Skeleton Proof 4.10: In Item (ii), it should say “For all $k \geq a$, if $P(k)$ is true, then $P(k + 1)$ is true.” as opposed to “For all $k \in \mathbb{Z} \dots$ ” [Ben Ford]
- Page 59, Theorem 4.25: Adjusted the statement of the Principle of Complete Mathematical Induction to reflect the situation when there are multiple cases to verify in the base step.
- Page 59, line 17: Removed spurious comma between “need” and “is”.
- Page 59, Skeleton Proof 4.26: The stated goal in the inductive step contained an extra universal quantifier. The extra phrase “for each $k \in \mathbb{N}$ ” has been removed. The skeleton has also been updated to reflect the changes in the statement of Theorem 4.25 to account for the situation when there are multiple cases to verify in the base step. In addition, the last sentence of the skeleton proof contained a copy-paste error from the previous skeleton proof. The phrase “for all integers $n \geq a$ ” has been replaced with “for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ ”. [Blake Farman]
- Page 60, Problem 4.32: Replaced “chessboard” with “grid”.
- Page 60, Problem 4.33: Deleted extra “the”. [Ellie Nichols]
- Page 60, Problem 4.33: In Item (i), the final string is missing a leading one. It should be “011101 $\rightarrow$ 111101”. [Ben Ford]
- Page 63, line 1: Missing the word “the” between “into” and “structure”.
- Page 63, line –6: Replaced the word “subtraction” with “multiplication”.
- Page 64: Retooled the paragraph above Theorem 5.2 in an attempt to clarify the existence versus uniqueness of additive and multiplicative identities. [inspired by suggestion from Alistair Windsor]
- Page 64, Theorem 5.2: Retooled theorem statement in an attempt to clarify the existence versus uniqueness of additive identity. [Inspired by suggestion from Alistair Windsor]
- Page 64, Theorem 5.3: Retooled theorem statement in an attempt to clarify the existence versus uniqueness of multiplicative identity. [Inspired by suggestion from Alistair Windsor]
- Page 64: Retooled paragraph prior to Theorem 5.4 in an attempt to clarify the existence versus uniqueness of additive and multiplicative inverses. In addition, a new paragraph was added after Theorem 5.5 to help further clarify the issue. Also added a comment about $-0 = 0$. [Inspired by suggestion from Alistair Windsor]
- Page 65, line –9: Corrected the definition of rational numbers, which had omitted the requirement that a and b be integers. [David Austin]
- Page 67, Theorem 5.21: Added “Moreover, if $a, b \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$ with $a < b$, then $b^{-1} < a^{-1}$.” This should probably be a separate result, but I didn’t want to mess up the numbering.

- Page 82, line –1: “counterexample” should be replaced with “contradiction”.
- Page 84: Three occurrences of $r < n$ and one occurrence of $r < |n|$ were replaced with $r < d$ and $r < |d|$, respectively. Two of these errors appeared in paragraph below proof of the Division Algorithm and the other two appeared in Problems 6.8 and 6.9. [Ryan Elwood]
- Page 101, Problem 7.47: Added the word “nonempty” to clarify that we are not considering the empty graph.
- Page 103, Theorem 7.59: Removed the word “nonempty” as the theorem holds even if A is the empty set. [David Deville]
- Page 103, Problem 7.60: In light of previous item, this problem has been replaced with “In the previous theorem, what is $A/\sim$ if A is the empty set?”
- Page 103, Problem 7.61: Replace “Find the partition determined by $\text{Rel}(\sim)$ ” with “Find $A/\sim$ and verify that it is a partition”.
- Page 104, Problem 7.65: Replaced “ $\sim$ ” with “ R ”.
- Page 104, Theorem 7.68: Removed the word “nonempty” as the theorem holds even if A is the empty set. [David Deville]
- Page 104, Problem 7.69: In light of previous item, this problem has been replaced with “In the previous theorem, what is R_Ω if A is the empty set?”
- Page 104, Problem 7.72: In light of changes to Theorem 7.59, Problem 7.60, Theorem 7.68, and Problem 7.69, this problem has been replaced with “Let $A = \{a, b, c\}$. If possible, find an example of collection Ω of nonempty subsets of A such that R_Ω is an equivalence relation on A but $\text{Rel}(R_\Omega) \neq \Omega$. If such an example is impossible, explain why.”
- Page 105, Corollary 7.74: As stated the corollary is incorrect. However, including the hypothesis “ $a \in \text{rel}(a)$ for all $a \in A$ ” makes the statement true. In addition, the word “nonempty” has been removed as the result still holds even if A is the empty set. I think it is incorrect to refer to this result as a “Corollary”, so it has been renamed “Theorem”. As a result, the reference to the result in Example 7.80 and the paragraph prior to Theorem 7.81 have been updated. A short paragraph about the new Theorem 7.74 has been added. [Blake Farman, David Deville]
- Page 106, Example 7.80 and paragraph prior to Theorem 7.81: “Corollary 7.74” replaced with “Theorem 7.74.”
- Page 113, Figure 8.1: Removed extra comma in caption.
- Page 117, Problems 8.24 and 8.25: Slightly reworded both problems and removed the phrase “well-defined function”, so that there is no confusion about whether a function could not be well defined.
- Page 120, Problem 8.35. There is no straightforward way to prove that the function in Part (d) is surjective, so I added the following comment: “*Note:* You are probably not in a position to write a careful argument for surjectivity for Part (d).”

- Page 128, Problem 8.66: It is impossible to find an example for Part (a) with the given sets. “Let $X = \{a, b\}$ and $Y = \{1, 2\}$ ” has been replaced with “Complete each of the following. Consider using finite sets and drawing a function diagram to define your functions.” [Blake Farman]
- Page 131, line 7: Corrected the spelling of “Definition.” [Pietro Monticone]
- Page 154, line 1: Added the word “us” between “tells” and “that”.
- Page 158, line 1: Added the word “look” between “you” and “at”. [Roy St. Laurent]
- Page 161, line 11: Removed spurious “)”. [Pietro Monticone]
- Page 163: Added alternative definition of “proposition” that aligns with Definition 2.16. [Inspired by David Austin]
- Page 192, Example 9.5: The original example was horribly wrong! It has been retooled. [Martha Brislen]